

takes longer than other antivirus packages, it uses up a lot less resources, which means that you can continue your work while the system is being checked.

One important feature missing from VirusScan 9.0 is a firewall or at least a port-blocking technology to stop unsolicited inbound packets. These days having a firewall on your system is a must, especially with the colossal rise in malicious software threats. Many other packages have spotted this danger and now come with inbuilt firewalls. If you already have a sturdy firewall running in your system and only need a good antivirus package that doesn't take its toll on your resources, then McAfee VirusScan Home 9.0 is definitely worth some consideration.

Pros: Improved interface; not too heavy on system resources.

Cons: No integrated firewall; no real-time spyware detection.

NOD32 Antivirus System 2.0

NOD32 is a multi-award winning antivirus package that's slowly gaining popularity as the antivirus to have. There are just too many strong features in NOD32 to sideline it while making a decision to buy an antivirus.

The NOD32 Antivirus System is essentially divided into four parts:

- NOD32 is the complete on demand and on schedule system scanner.
- AMON is a real time scanner that checks files on access.
- DMON protects the system from viruses contained in various documents such as macro viruses in Microsoft Word documents.
- IMON scans incoming POP3 and HTTP streams protecting you from Web and e-mail threats.